

First Analysis Paper

Link: [Frank & The Nurse | Tim Hortons Holiday Commercial 2024](#)

1. The Tim Hortons holiday commercial uses a heartwarming story with a theme of “Caring is a Gift” to grab customer attention. The emotional story is about an elderly man called Frank who is recovering in the hospital and the nurse who is willing to help and encourage him to move out of his bed by giving him a Timbits, showcasing the power of kindness that could be given through simple things such as sharing Timbits. This storytelling approach makes the commercial memorable, as it not only promotes Tim Hortons as a food brand, but also the brand that values kindness and caring for others. This emotional story will ultimately build customer emotional connection with the brand and enhance customer’s memory encoding.

Furthermore, this commercial video also leverages the principle of sensory marketing, especially sights and sounds stimuli. The iconic red Tim Hortons Cup was shown in the beginning which makes the ad eye-catching and helps people recognize the brand quickly. It also strengthens the “sight stimulus” through using the Timbits as a symbol of caring to people. The cinematic videography makes the ad look professional and visually appealing, so it can attract customer’s voluntary attention to watch the ad until the end. Additionally, the dramatic background music serves as a strong sound stimulus, strengthening the emotional effect and making the ad more touching and memorable.

In addition, the ad also addresses deeper consumer needs beyond just satisfying hunger. According to Maslow’s Hierarchy of Needs, Tim Hortons as a food brand typically fulfills physiological needs like hunger. However, this ad goes further by positioning Tim Hortons as a brand that also fulfills belongingness needs by emphasizing human connection. In this ad, Tim Hortons positions itself to meet hedonic needs instead of just utilitarian needs. This makes Tim Hortons not just a place to get coffee and donuts but also a brand that represents kindness.

By combining storytelling and sensory marketing, the ad can capture customer attention and potentially shape their perception of the brand. A positive brand perception is very crucial, since customer’s purchasing decisions are influenced not only by immediate needs but also by how customers feel about a brand. As a result, strong brand recognition and positive associations from this ad can ultimately influence customer purchasing decisions and drive sales growth.

2. While Tim Hortons commercials already use principal sensory marketing to reinforce the emotional appeals, it can still be improved by focusing more on the product itself as well. For example, adding close-up shots of characters eating Timbits and sipping Tim Hortons coffee, along with their expressions of enjoyment. This scene can serve as taste stimuli, making the food and drinks look more desirable.

I also propose adding a catchy short slogan at the end of the ad instead of just displaying the Tim Hortons logo. A slogan like “It’s Time for Tims” or “Tims for Good” would make the brand easier to remember. To strengthen brand recall, the ad should display the slogan with a voiceover. Hearing the slogan while seeing the brand logo would help consumers recognize the brand more effectively rather than just displaying the logo.

Additionally, the ad could benefit from the borrowed interest strategy by featuring a popular Canadian celebrity. For example, Tim Hortons could collaborate with Ryan Gosling to enhance the ad’s appeal. They could include an additional scene where Ryan Gosling, playing as Frank’s adopted son, visits him while bringing a package of Tim Hortons products, including Timbits. In the final shot, they could share the meal together with the nurse, creating a warm and emotional moment.

I chose Ryan Gosling because he is very popular and has a good reputation, especially after the success of the Barbie movie. As a well-known Canadian actor, he connects with both local and international

audiences, making him a great fit for Tim Hortons that is deeply rooted in Canadian culture. His likable and down-to-earth personality matches Tim Hortons' values of kindness. He also appeals to many age groups, from longtime fans of his earlier movies to younger audiences who recently discovered him through Barbie movie. By featuring a celebrity with a positive image, Tim Hortons can grab more attention, improve brand recognition, and build a stronger emotional connection with viewers.

This strategy would attract more audience, as Ryan Gosling's fans would be more likely to watch the ad, even if they weren't initially interested in Tim Hortons. Even though they watch it just because of the celebrity, it still increases brand exposure since the celebrity becomes associated with the brand through the ad. If the ad delivers a strong emotional appeal while effectively showcasing the taste of the product, it can leave a lasting impression and create a positive perception of the brand. This positive perception could ultimately encourage viewers to try Tim Hortons and influence their purchasing decisions.

3. To evaluate the effectiveness of the proposed improvements to the Tim Hortons commercial, I would use online surveys and experimental research to collect quantitative data. These methods provide measurable insights into consumer behavior, focusing on both descriptive and causal relationships, making it possible to assess the impact of the new ad proposal.

The first method is doing online surveys as it is cost-effective and can easily reach more people. Since the ad would likely be viewed on YouTube and social media, an online survey would ensure that feedback is gathered from a diverse audience. The survey would include structured, multiple-choice, and Likert-scale questions designed to measure brand recall, emotional engagement, and purchase intent.

In this survey, I would collect descriptive quantitative data to measure audience perceptions and responses to the ad. The surveys would include structured questions such as "How likely are you to visit Tim Hortons after watching the ad?" (on a scale 1-5) or "What part of the ad was most memorable for you?" (multiple choice). Additional questions, such as rating the emotional impact of the ad on a scale of 1-5, would provide further insights into the audience's connection with the content. The data collected would highlight the effectiveness of additional elements like the slogan, product close-ups, or celebrity appearances in building emotional connection to customers and shape customer perception. These results would guide decisions on which aspects of the ad resonate most with viewers and identify areas for improvement.

The second method is experimental research. In this method, I would collect causal quantitative data by comparing the performance of two versions of the ad. One group (the control) would view the original ad, while another group (the treatment group) would watch the improved version with the proposed changes. Metrics such as viewing behavior (watching time and skip rates), engagement levels (click-through rates or searches for Tim Hortons), and purchase behavior (store visits or sales) would be analyzed. By comparing the results from both groups, this method would help determine whether the improved ad leads to higher engagement, stronger recall, and increased purchase behavior. If the treatment group shows significantly better performance, it would confirm that the proposed changes positively impact consumer behavior.

By combining the descriptive insights from online surveys with the causal evidence from experimental research, these strategies would provide a comprehensive understanding of how the ad improvements impact consumer behavior. The quantitative data collected would enable Tim Hortons to make informed decisions to optimize the ad's effectiveness and drive better marketing outcomes.